

Key Takeaways: IAM

Estimated time needed: 5 minutes

- IAM (Identity and Access Management) is a web service that securely controls access to resources.
- 4As of Identity and access management:
 - **Administration:** It involves determining the current access rights and also creating them. Administration involves creating, updating, and deleting accounts.
 - **Authentication:** It involves determining the identity of the person who needs access.
 - **Authorization:** It involves determining what should be done and what shouldn't be done
 - **Audit:** It involves analysis of the three A's (above) and ensuring that it is adhered to.
- Any information about a user is called identity.
- The place a user identity is saved is referred to as a directory.
- A directory comprises of a database, a schema, a protocol (most commonly used, Lightweight Directory Access Protocol (LDAP)).
- Ways to approach Synchronization:
 - **Virtual directory:** It retrieves the information based on the request sent by the user.
 - **Meta directory:** It takes the information, pre-fetches it, and stores it up to an enterprise directory.
- Privilege Access Management (PAM) monitors and prevents unauthorized privileged access to critical resources.
- A federation capability helps to log in a system as an identity provider and access other systems as a service provider.
- Workforce identity management refers to the processes, tools, and strategies used to manage the workforce.
- Consumer Identity and Access Management (CIAM) is used to integrate both authentication and authorization into customer-facing applications.

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